

The Proem of the Poem (D4)

D4 (B1) v. 1–30: Sext. Emp. *Adv. Math.* 7.111 (et al.); v. 28–32: Simpl. *In Cael.*, pp. 557.25–558.2 (et al.)

ἐναρχόμενος γοῦν τοῦ Περὶ φύσεως γράφει τοῦτον
τὸν τρόπον

ἵπποι ταί με φέρουσιν, ὅσον τ' ἐπὶ θυμὸς
ικάνοι,

πέμπον ἐπεὶ μ' ἐς ὁδὸν βῆσαν πολύφημον
ἄγουσαι

δαίμονος, ἧ κατὰ πάντ' ἄστη φέρει εἰδότα
φῶτα·

τῇ φερόμην· τῇ γάρ με πολύφραστοι φέρον
ἵπποι

5 ἄρμα τιταίνουσαι, κοῦραι δ' ὁδὸν ἡγεμόνευον.

ἄξων δ' ἐν χνοίησιν ἱεὶ σύριγγος αὔτην

αἰθόμενος (δοιοῖς γὰρ ἐπείγετο δινωτοῖσιν

κύκλοις ἀμφοτέρωθεν), ὅτε σπερχοῖατο πέμπειν

Ἑλιάδες κοῦραι, προλιποῦσαι δώματα Νυκτός

10 εἰς φάος, ὡσάμεναι κράτων ἀπο χερσὶ

καλύπτρας.

3 πάντ' ἄστη (falso) legit Mutschmann: παντατῇ (cum variis
accentibus) mss.: alii aliter 6 χνοίησιν ἱεὶ Diels post
Karsten: χνοῖησιν N: χνοιῖσιν LEABVR 10 κράτων
Mullach post Karsten: κρατερῶν mss.

PARMENIDES

The Proem of the Poem (D4)

D4 (B1) Sextus Empiricus, *Against the Logicians*

At the beginning of his *On Nature* he writes as follows:

[The journey to the goddess]

**The mares that carry me as far as ardor might
go**

**Were bringing me onward, after having led me
and set me down on the divinity's many-
worded**

**Road, which carries through all the towns (?)
the man who knows.**

**It was on this road that I was being carried: for
on it the much-knowing horses were carrying
me,**

Straining at the chariot, and maidens were 5
leading the way.

**The axle in the naves emitted the whistle of a
flute**

**As it was heated (for it was pressed hard by two
whirling**

**Wheels, one on each side), while the maidens of
the Sun**

**Hastened to bring me, after they had left
behind the palace of Night**

Towards the light¹ and had pushed back the 10
veils from their heads with their hands.

¹ Interpreters have often understood "hastened to bring me . . . toward the light," not "after they had left behind . . . toward the light."

ἔνθα πύλαι Νυκτός τε καὶ Ἥματός εἰσι
κελεύθων,

καὶ σφας ὑπέρθυρον ἀμφὶς ἔχει καὶ λαῖνος
οὐδός·

αὐταὶ δ' αἰθέριαι πλήνται μεγάλοισι θυρέτροις·
τῶν δὲ Δίκη πολύποινος ἔχει κληῖδας ἀμοιβούς·

15 τὴν δὴ παρφάμεναι κοῦραι μαλακοῖσι λόγοισιν
πείσαν ἐπιφραδέως, ὥς σφιν βαλανωτὸν ὀχῆα
ἀπτερέως ὥσειε πυλέων ἄπο· ταὶ δὲ θυρέτρων
χάσμ' ἀχανὲς ποίησαν ἀναπτάμεναι
πολυχάλκους

20 ἄξονας ἐν σύριγξιν ἀμοιβαδὸν εἰλίξασαι
γόμφοις καὶ περόνησιν ἀρηρότε· τῇ ῥα δι'
αὐτέων

ἰθὺς ἔχον κοῦραι κατ' ἀμαξιτὸν ἄρμα καὶ
ἵππους.

καὶ με θεὰ πρόφρων ὑπεδέξατο, χεῖρα δὲ χειρὶ
δεξιτερὴν ἔλεν, ὧδε δ' ἔπος φάτο καὶ με
προσηύδα·

25 ὦ κοῦρ' ἀθανάτοισι συνάορος ἡνιόχοισιν,
ἵπποις ταί σε φέρουσιν ἰκάνων ἡμέτερον δῶ,

14 Δίκη Scaliger: δίκην mss.

PARMENIDES

**That is where the gate of the paths of Night and
Day is,²**

**And a lintel and a stone threshold hold it on
both sides.**

**Itself ethereal, it is occupied by great doors,
And much-punishing Justice holds its
alternating keys.**

**The maidens, cajoling her with gentle words, 15
Wisely persuaded her to thrust quickly back for
them**

**The bolted bar from the gate. And when it flew
open**

**It made a gaping absence of the doors, after
rotating in turn**

**In their sockets the two bronze pivots
Fastened with pegs and rivets. There, through 20
them,**

**The maidens guided the chariot and horses
straight along the way.**

**And the goddess welcomed me graciously, took
my right hand**

**In her own hand, and spoke these words,
addressing me:**

[The beginning of the goddess' speech]

**Young man, companion of deathless charioteers,
you who**

**Have come to our home by the mares that carry 25
you,**

² Cf. COSM. T8, T9.

χαίρ', ἐπεὶ οὔτι σε μοῖρα κακὴ προὔπεμπε
 νέεσθαι
 τήνδ' ὁδόν (ἧ γὰρ ἀπ' ἀνθρώπων ἐκτὸς πάτου
 ἐστίν),
 ἀλλὰ Θέμις τε Δίκη τε. χρεὼ δέ σε πάντα
 πυθέσθαι
 ἡμὲν Ἀληθείης εὐπειθέος ἀτρεμεὺς ἦτορ
 30 ἡδὲ βροτῶν δόξας, ταῖς οὐκ ἔνι πίστις ἀληθής.
 ἀλλ' ἔμπησ καὶ ταῦτα μαθήσαιο, ὥς τὰ
 δοκοῦντα
 χρῆν δοκίμως εἶναι διὰ παντὸς πάντα περῶντα.

29 εὐπειθέος Plut. *Adv. Col.* 1114D, Clem. Alex. *Strom.*
 5.59.6, Diog. Laert. 9.22: εὐκυκλέος Simpl.: εὐφεγγέος Procl. *In*
Tim. 2. 105b post v. 30 hab. Sextus D8.2–6a = B7.2–6
 D.–K. 32 χρῆν DE: χρῆν A: χρῆ Karsten περῶντα
 A: περ ὄντα DEF

*Fragments from the First Part, on Truth, and
 Transition to the Second Part (D5–D8)*

D5 (B5) Procl. *In Parm.*, p. 708.10–11

– υ υ | – υ υ | – υ υ | – ξυνὸν δέ μοί ἐστιν,
 ὁππόθεν ἄρξωμαι τόθι γὰρ πάλιν ἵξομαι αὖθις.

PARMENIDES

**I greet you [or: Rejoice!]: for it is no evil fate that
has sent you to travel**

**This road (for indeed it is remote from the
paths of men),**

**But Right and Justice. It is necessary that you
learn everything,**

**Both the unshakeable heart of well-convincing
(*eupeitheos*) truth**

**And the opinions of mortals, in which there is 30
no true belief (*pistis*).**

**But nonetheless you will learn this too: how
opinions**

**Would have to be acceptable, forever
penetrating all things (?)³**

³ The text of the second half of the line is uncertain.

*Fragments from the First Part, on Truth, and
Transition to the Second Part (D5–D8)*

D5 (B5) Proclus, *Commentary on Plato's Parmenides*

**In common, for me, is
The point from which I shall begin: for I shall
return there once again later.**

D6 (B2, B3) v. 1–8a: Procl. *In Tim.*, 2.105b13–22; v. 3–8a: Simpl. *In Phys.*, pp. 116.28–117.1 (et al.); v. 8b: Clem. Alex. *Strom.* 6.23.3 (et al.)

- [B2] εἰ δ' ἄγ' ἐγὼν ἐρέω, κόμισαι δὲ σὺ μῦθον
 ἀκούσας,
 αἶπερ ὁδοὶ μῶναι διζήσιός εἰσι νοῆσαι·
 ἢ μὲν ὅπως ἔστιν τε καὶ ὥς οὐκ ἔστι μὴ εἶναι,
 πειθοῦς ἔστι κέλευθος (ἀληθείη γὰρ ὀπηδεῖ),
 5 ἢ δ' ὥς οὐκ ἔστιν τε καὶ ὥς χρεῶν ἔστι μὴ
 εἶναι,
 τὴν δὴ τοι φράζω παναπευθέα ἔμμεν ἀταρπὸν·
 οὔτε γὰρ ἂν γνοίης τό γε μὴ ἔδον (οὐ γὰρ
 ἀνυστόν)
 [B3] οὔτε φράσαις. τὸ γὰρ αὐτὸ νοεῖν ἐστίν τε καὶ
 εἶναι.

1 ἄγ' ἐγὼν Karsten: ἄγε τῶν mss. 3 ὥς Simpl.: om.
 Procl. 6 παναπευθέα Simpl. EF: παραπεύθεα Simpl. D:
 παναπειθέα Procl. P: παραπειθέα Procl. N 7 ἀνυστόν
 Simpl.: ἐφικτόν Procl.

D6 (B2) Proclus, *Commentary on Plato's Timaeus* (et al.)
+ (B3) Clement of Alexandria, *Stromata* (et al.).

Well then, as for me, I shall say—and as for you, [B2]
have a care for this discourse when you have
heard it—

What are the only roads of investigation for
thought (*noêσαι*):

The one, that “is,” and that it is not possible
that “is not,”

Is the path of conviction (*peithô*), **for it**
accompanies truth;

The other, that “is not,” and that it is necessary 5
that “is not”—

I show you that it is a path that cannot be
inquired into at all.

For you could not know that which is not (for
this is impracticable)

Nor could you show it.

For it is the same, to [B3]
think (*noein*) **and also to be.**¹

¹ This phrase is transmitted separately from the preceding lines, but it completes them in meaning and meter, and it is plausibly attached to them by scholars. For the meaning, cf. **D8.39–41.**

D7 (B6) v. 1–2a (. . . ἔστιν): Simpl. *In Phys.*, p. 86.27–28;
v. 1b (ἔστι . . .)–9: Simpl. *In Phys.*, p. 117.4–13; v. 8–9a
(. . . ταῦτόν): Simpl. *In Phys.*, p. 78.3–4

χρὴ τὸ λέγειν τε νοεῖν τ' ἐὼν ἔμμεναι· ἔστι γὰρ
εἶναι·

μηδὲν δ' οὐκ ἔστιν· τά γ' ἐγὼ φράζεσθαι
ἄνωγα.

πρώτης γάρ σ' ἀφ' ὁδοῦ ταύτης διζήσιος
<εἵργω>,

αὐτὰρ ἔπειτ' ἀπὸ τῆς, ἣν δὴ βροτοὶ εἰδότες
οὐδέν

- 5 πλάττονται, δίκρανοι ἀμηχανίη γὰρ ἐν αὐτῶν
στήθεσιν ἰθύνει πλαγκτὸν νόον· οἱ δὲ φοροῦνται
κωφοὶ ὁμῶς τυφλοὶ τε, τεθηπότες, ἄκριτα φύλα,
οἷς τὸ πέλειν τε καὶ οὐκ εἶναι ταῦτόν
νενόμισται
κοῦ ταῦτόν, πάντων δὲ παλίντροπὸς ἔστι
κέλευθος.

1 τε Karsten: τὸ mss. τεὸν F: τὸ ὄν DE, corr. Brandis
2 τά γ' ἐγὼ D: τά γε F: τοῦ ἐγὼ E: τά σε ed. Ald.: τά σ' ἐγὼ
Bergk 3 σ' mss. optimi: τ' scrips. Cordero cum mss. BC
<εἵργω> Diels: <ἄρξει> Cordero: <ἄρξω> Nehamas 5 πλάτ-
τονται mss.: πλάζονται ed. Ald.

D7 (B6) Simplicius, *Commentary on Aristotle's Physics*

**It is necessary to say and to think that this is
being;¹ for it is possible that it is,²
While nothing is not: that is exactly what I bid
you to meditate.
For such is the first road of investigation from
which <I keep> you <away>,
But then also from this one,³ which mortals who
know nothing
Invent (*plattontai*),⁴ two-headed [scil. creatures]! 5
For the helplessness in their
Breast directs their wandering (*plankton*)
thought; and they are borne along,
Deaf and likewise blind, stupefied, tribes
undecided [or: without judgment],
Who suppose that "this is and is not" [or: that to
be and not to be] is the same
And not the same, and that of all things [or: for
all] the path is backward-turning.⁵**

¹ Or else: "It is necessary to say and to think this: that being [i.e. that which is] is." Several recent editors accept the transmitted text, translating either "It is necessary to say that this, and to think that this, is being," or "It is necessary to say this and to think this, viz. that being is." ² Or: "for being is" vel sim. But it is difficult to suppose that a nonsubstantivized infinitive could be the subject of a verb. ³ Or, adopting other supplements instead of Diels': "for such is the first road of investigation [i.e. the one indicated in lines 1–2a] by which <you [or: I] will begin>, / But then also from this one [scil. corresponding to the latter part of the poem]." ⁴ Or: "where mortals . . . wander." ⁵ Probably an allusion to Heraclitus, cf. **HER. D65, R15.**

D8 (B7 et B8) v. 1–2: Plat. *Soph.* 237a et 258d; Simpl. *In Phys.*, pp. 244.1–2, 135.21–22, 143.30–144.1 (et al.); v. 1: Arist. *Metaph.* N2 1089a4; v. 2–7a (. . . λείπεται): Sext. *Adv. Math.* 7.111 (et al.); v. 6b (μόνος . . .)–57: Simpl. *In Phys.*, pp. 145.1–146.25 (et al.); v. 48–50: Plat. *Soph.* 244e; v. 55–66: Simpl. *In Phys.*, pp. 38.30–39.9; v. 58–64: Simpl. *In Phys.*, pp. 30.23–31.2, 180.1–7 (et al.)

- [B7.1] οὐ γὰρ μήποτε τοῦτο δαμῇ εἶναι μὴ ἔοντα·
ἀλλὰ σὺν τῇσδ' ἀφ' ὁδοῦ διζήσιος εἶργε νόημα
μηδέ σ' ἔθος πολύπειρον ὁδὸν κατὰ τήνδε
βιάσθω
νωμᾶν ἄσκοπον ὄμμα καὶ ἡχῆεσσιν ἀκουήν
5 καὶ γλῶσσαν, κρίναι δὲ λόγῳ πολύδηριν
ἔλεγχον
ἐξ ἐμέθεν ῥηθέντα. [B8] μόνος δ' ἔτι μῦθος
ὁδοῖο
λείπεται ὥς ἔστιν· ταύτῃ δ' ἐπὶ σήματ' ἔασι
πολλὰ μάλ', ὥς ἀγένητον ἐὼν καὶ ἀνώλεθρόν
ἐστιν,
οὐλον μουννογενές τε καὶ ἀτρεμές ἡδ' ἀτέλεστον·
10 [B8.5] οὐδέ ποτ' ἦν οὐδ' ἔσται, ἐπεὶ νῦν ἔστιν ὁμοῦ
πάν,

1 τοῦτο δαμῇ Ar. EJ, Simpl. *In Phys.* p. 135 (E); p. 143 (DE), p. 244 (E): τοῦτ' οὐ δαμῇ (vel τοῦτ' οὐδαμῇ vel -ῇ) Plat., Ar. A^b, Simpl. p. 244 (F) 9 οὐλον μουννογενές Clem. Alex. *Strom.* 5.112.2; Simpl. (μονογενές) *In Cael.* p. 556, *In Phys.* p. 29 (DE), p. 120 (D), p. 145 (E), al.: ἔστι γὰρ οὐλομελές Plut. *Adv. Col.* 1114C: μῶνον, μουννογενές Eus. *PE* 13.13.39 et al.: alii alia

PARMENIDES

D8 (B7, B8)¹ Plato, *Sophist*; Sextus Empiricus, *Against the Logicians*; Simplicius, *Commentary on Aristotle's Physics* (et al.)

For never at all could you master this: that [B7.1]
things that are not are.

But as for you, keep your thought away from
this road of investigation

And do not let much-experienced [or: much-
experiencing] **habit force you down onto**
this road,

To wield an aimless eye and an echoing ear
And tongue—no, by the argument (*logos*) decide 5
the much-disputed refutation (*elenkhos*)

Spoken by me. [B8] There only remains the
word of the path [scil. that says]:

“Is.” On this one there are signs,
Very many of them: that being, it [or: that what is]
is ungenerated, indestructible,

Complete, single-born, untrembling and
unending [scil. probably: in time].²

And was not, nor will it be at some time, since it 10 [B8.5]
is now, together, whole,

¹ The two fragments were separated by Diels despite the citation by Sextus, which allows them to be combined. ² Given that Parmenides' being is elsewhere considered to be limited ("not . . . incomplete," **D8.37**), many interpreters consider this term to be corrupt.

ἀτέλεστον Simpl. *In Phys.* p. 30, p. 78 (*ἀτέλευτον* ed. Ald.):
ἀγένητον Simpl. *In Cael.* p. 556, *In Phys.* p. 120, Plut. *Adv. Col.*
1114C, Clem. Alex. *Strom.* 5.112.2, Eus. *PE* 13.13.39, al.

ἐν, συνεχές· τίνα γὰρ γένναν διζήσαι αὐτοῦ;
 πῇ πόθεν αὐξηθέν; οὐτ' ἐκ μὴ ἐόντος ἑάσω
 φάσθαι σ' οὐδὲ νοεῖν· οὐ γὰρ φατὸν οὐδὲ

νοητόν

ἔστιν ὅπως οὐκ ἔστι. τί δ' ἂν μιν καὶ χρέος
 ὤρσεν

15
 [B8.10]

ὑστερον ἢ πρόσθεν, τοῦ μηδενὸς ἀρξάμενον,
 φύν;

οὕτως ἢ πάμπαν πέλεναι χρεῶν ἔστιν ἢ οὐχί.
 οὐδέ ποτ' ἐκ μὴ ἐόντος ἐφήσει πίστιος ἰσχύς
 γίγνεσθαι τι παρ' αὐτό· τοῦ εἵνεκεν οὔτε

γενέσθαι

20
 [B8.15]

οὐτ' ὀλλυσθαι ἀνῆκε Δίκη χαλάσασα πέδησιν,
 ἀλλ' ἔχει· ἢ δὲ κρίσις περὶ τούτων ἐν τῷδ'

ἔστιν·

ἔστιν ἢ οὐκ ἔστιν· κέκριται δ' οὖν, ὥσπερ
 ἀνάγκη,

τὴν μὲν εἶναι ἀνόητον ἀνώνυμον (οὐ γὰρ ἀληθής
 ἔστιν ὁδός), τὴν δ' ὥστε πέλειν καὶ ἐτήτυμον
 εἶναι.

πῶς δ' ἂν ἔπειτα πέλοι τὸ ἐόν; πῶς δ' ἂν κε
 γένοιτο;

17 ἐκ μὴ ἐόντος Diels: ἐκ (vel ἔκ γε) μὴ ὄντος Simpl. In
Phys. p. 78, 145: ἐκ τοῦ ἐόντος Karsten 24 ἔπειτα πέλοι
 τὸ mss. (πέλοιο F): ἔπειτ' ἀπόλοιο Kranz post Karsten et Stein

³ Many interpreters, relying especially on the paraphrase that Simplicius seems to be making of this passage (cf. **R21**), correct to “out of what is.”

PARMENIDES

One, continuous. For what birth could you seek
for it?

How, from what could it have grown? Not from
what is not—I shall not allow

You to say nor to think this: for it cannot be said
nor thought

That “is not”; and what need could have
impelled it

To grow later rather than sooner, if it had had
nothing for its beginning? 15 [B8.10]

So it is necessary that it either be completely or
not at all.

And neither will any force of belief (*pistis*) ever
affirm that out of what is not³

Something is born besides itself. That is why
Justice

Has not, loosening its fetters, allowed it either
to be born or to be destroyed,

But holds it fast. The decision (*krisis*) on these
matters depends upon this: 20 [B8.15]

“Is” or “is not”? Well, it has been decided, as is
necessary,

To abandon the one [scil. road] as unthinkable,
unnameable (for it is not

The true road), and [scil. deciding] thereby that
the other, by consequence, exists and is
real.⁴

How then could what is exist afterward? And
how could it be born?

⁴ Or: “to admit that the one [scil. road] is unthinkable . . . and
[scil. to admit] thereby that the other exists. . . .”

25
[B8.20]

εἰ γὰρ ἔγεντ', οὐκ ἔστ' οὐδ' εἴ ποτε μέλλει
ἔσεσθαι.

τὼς γένεσις μὲν ἀπέσβησται καὶ ἄπυστος
ὄλεθρος.

οὐδὲ διαιρετόν ἐστιν, ἐπεὶ πᾶν ἐστὶν ὁμοῖον·
οὐδέ τι τῇ μάλλον, τό κεν εἴργοι μιν

συνέχεσθαι,

οὐδέ τι χειρότερον, πᾶν δ' ἔμπλεόν ἐστιν
έόντος.

30
[B8.25]

τῷ ξυνεχὲς πᾶν ἐστὶν· ἐὼν γὰρ ἐόντι πελάζει.

αὐτὰρ ἀκίνητον μεγάλων ἐν πείρασι δεσμῶν

ἐστὶν ἄναρχον ἄπυστον, ἐπεὶ γένεσις καὶ
ὄλεθρος

τῇλε μάλ' ἐπλάχθησαν, ἀπῶσε δὲ πίστις
ἀληθής.

ταὐτὸν τ' ἐν ταὐτῷ τε μένον καθ' ἑαυτό τε
κεῖται

35
[B8.30]

χοῦτως ἔμπεδον αὖθι μένει· κρατερὴ γὰρ
Ἀνάγκη

πείρατος ἐν δεσμοῖσιν ἔχει, τό μιν ἀμφὶς
ἔέργει,

οὐνεκεν οὐκ ἀτελεύτητον τὸ ἐὼν θέμις εἶναι·

ἔστι γὰρ οὐκ ἐπιδενές· ἐὼν δ' ἂν παντὸς ἐδεῖτο.

ταὐτὸν δ' ἐστὶ νοεῖν τε καὶ οὐνεκεν ἔστι νόημα.

38 ἐπιδενές Simpl. *In Phys.* p. 30 (EF), p. 40 (E^a ed. Ald.),
p. 146: ἐπιδεές Simpl. p. 40 (DEF), p. 30 (DE) μὴ post
ἐπιδενές del. Bergk

PARMENIDES

For if it was born, it is not, not any more than if 25
 it is going to be someday. [B8.20]
 In this way birth is extinguished, and
 unknowable destruction.
 Nor is it divisible, since as a whole it is similar,
 Nor at all more here, which would prevent it
 from cohering,
 Nor at all weaker, but as a whole it is full of
 being.
 That is why as a whole it is continuous: for what 30
 is is adjacent to what is. [B8.25]
 Moreover, motionless within the limits of its
 great bonds,
 It is without beginning, without ending, since
 birth and destruction
 Went wandering very far away—true belief
 (*pistis*) thrust them away.
 Remaining the same and in the same [scil. place],
 it rests in itself
 And thus remains stable there; for powerful 35
 Necessity [B8.30]
 Holds it fast within the bonds of the limit, which
 confines it on all sides [or: keeps it separate].
 That is why it is not allowed that what is (*to eon*)
 be incomplete.
 For it is not lacking [scil. something]; if it were, it
 would lack everything.
 This is the same: to think and the thought that
 “is.”

- 40 οὐ γὰρ ἄνευ τοῦ ἐόντος, ἐν ᾧ πεφαισμένον
 [B8.35] ἐστίν,
 εὐρήσεις τὸ νοεῖν· οὐδὲν γὰρ <ἦ> ἔστιν ἢ ἔσται
 ἄλλο πάρεξ τοῦ ἐόντος, ἐπεὶ τό γε Μοῖρ'
 ἐπέδησεν
 οὐλον ἀκίνητόν τ' ἔμεναι τῷ πάντ' ὄνομ' ἔσται,
 ὅσσα βροτοὶ κατέθεντο πεποιθότες εἶναι ἀληθῆ,
 45 γίγνεσθαι τε καὶ ὄλλυσθαι, εἶναί τε καὶ οὐχί,
 [B8.40] καὶ τόπον ἀλλάσσειν διὰ τε χροῶ φανὸν
 ἀμείβειν.
 αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ πείρας πύματον, τετελεσμένον ἐστί
 πάντοθεν, εὐκύκλου σφαίρης ἐναλίγκιον ὄγκῳ,
 μεσσόθεν ἰσοπαλὲς πάντη· τὸ γὰρ οὔτε τι
 μεῖζον
 50 οὔτε τι βαιότερον πελέναι χρεῶν ἐστί τῇ ἢ τῇ.
 [B8.45] οὔτε γὰρ οὐκ ἐὼν ἔστι, τό κεν παύοι μιν
 ἱκνεῖσθαι
 εἰς ὁμόν, οὔτ' ἐὼν ἔστιν ὅπως εἴη κεν ἐόντος
 τῇ μᾶλλον τῇ δ' ἦσσαν, ἐπεὶ πᾶν ἐστὶν ἄσυλον·
 οἱ γὰρ πάντοθεν ἴσον, ὁμῶς ἐν πείρασι κύρει.

41 οὐδὲν γὰρ Simpl. *In Phys.* p. 86: οὐδ' εἰ χρόνος ἐστὶν
 Simpl. p. 146: οὐδὲ χρόνος Coxon <ἦ> Preller 43 ὄνομ'
 ἔσται Simpl. *In Phys.* p. 87 (F): οὐνομα ἔσται (D): ὄνομ' ἐστὶν
 p. 146 ed. Ald.; cf. ὄνομ' εἶναι Plat. *Theaet.* 180e et al.: ὀνόμα-
 σται Simpl. *In Phys.* p. 87 (E), p. 146 (DE): ὠνόμασται p. 146
 (F) 50 χρεῶν Simpl. p. 146, p. 52, p. 89, Plat. *Soph.* 244e YW:
 χρεόν Plat. BT 52 κεν Brandis: καὶ ἐν mss.: κενὸν ed. Ald.

5 Or, with another reading: "it is in virtue of this [scil. of that which is] that all things have been named."

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For without what is, in which it [scil. thinking] is 40
spoken, [B8.35]
You will not find thinking. For nothing else
<either> is or will be
Besides what is, since Destiny has bound this
To be whole and unmovable: so that a [scil.
mere] name will be all the things⁵
About which mortals have established,
convinced that they are true,
That they are born and are destroyed,⁶ are and 45
are not, [B8.40]
Change their place and modify their bright
color.
Moreover, since its limit is most distant, it is
completed
On every side, similar to the volume of a well-
rounded ball,
Everywhere balanced equally starting from its
center: for it must be
Neither at all bigger nor at all smaller here than 50
there. [B8.45]
For neither is there nonbeing (*ouk eon*), which
could stop it from reaching
What is similar to it; nor is there being so that
of being there would be
More here and less there, since as a whole it is
inviolable.
For, equal to itself on every side, it maintains
itself in its limits, similarly.

⁶ Or: "all the things that mortals have posited, convinced that they are true, / Are born and are destroyed. . . ."

- 55
[B8.50] ἐν τῷ σοι παύω πιστὸν λόγον ἡδὲ νόημα
ἀμφὶς ἀληθείης· δόξας δ' ἀπὸ τοῦδε βροτείας
μάνθανε κόσμον ἐμῶν ἐπέων ἀπατηλὸν ἀκούων.
μορφὰς γὰρ κατέθεντο δύο γνώμας ὀνομάζειν
τῶν μίαν οὐ χρεῶν ἐστίν (ἐν ᾧ πεπλανημένοι
εἰσίν),
- 60
[B8.55] ἀντία δ' ἐκρίναντο δέμας καὶ σήματ' ἔθεντο
χωρὶς ἀπ' ἀλλήλων, τῇ μὲν φλογὸς αἰθέριον
πῦρ,
ἥπιον ὄν, μέγ' ἐλαφρόν, ἐωυτῷ πάντοσε τωῦτόν,
τῷ δ' ἐτέρῳ μὴ τωῦτόν· ἀτὰρ κακείνο κατ' αὐτό
τὰντία νύκτ' ἄδαῃ, πυκινὸν δέμας ἐμβριθές τε.
65
[B8.60] τὸν σοι ἐγὼ διάκοσμον εἰκότα πάντα φατίζω,
ὥς οὐ μή ποτέ τίς σε βροτῶν γνώμη
παρελάσσει.

58 γνώμας Simpl. p. 39: γνώμαις p. 30 (p. 39 ed. Ald.)
60 ἀντία Simpl. (ἐναντία p. 30 DE): τὰντία Diels (cf. v. 64)
62 post μέγ' habet ἀραιὸν Simpl. p. 30, del. (ut gloss.) Diels
65 φατίζω Simpl.: φατίσω Karsten

PARMENIDES

[Transition to the second part of the poem]
At this point, for you I stop the argument 55
worthy of belief (*piston*) and the thought [B8.50]
(noêma)
About truth; from here on learn mortal opinions
By listening to the deceptive arrangement of my
words.
For they have established two forms to name
their views,
Of which the one is not necessary⁷—in this they
wander in error—
And they have divided their body into opposites 60
and posited signs [B8.55]
Separate from each other: for the one, the
ethereal fire of flame,
Being mild, very light in weight, the same as
itself everywhere,
And not the same as the other one; and that one
too, in itself,
The opposite, night without knowledge [or:
without light], a dense and heavy body.
I tell you this arrangement of the world, 65
adapted (*eoikos*)⁸ in every point, [B8.60]
So that no conception (*gnômê*) of mortals might
ever get past you.

⁷ The construction and meaning are controversial. We understand that the error of mortals consists in their relating the two forms distinguished to that which is and to that which is not, whereas both of them ought to be related to that which is.

⁸ 'Adapted' or 'resembling' or both.

*Fragments and Reports from the Second Part of
the Poem: The Opinions of Mortals (D9–D62)*

*An Overview of the Contents of the
Second Part (D9)*

D9 (cf. ad B10) Plut. *Adv. Col.* 13 1114B–C

[. . .] Παρμενίδης [. . . = **R53a**] καὶ διάκοσμον πεποίη-
ται, καὶ στοιχεῖα μιγνύς, τὸ λαμπρὸν καὶ σκοτεινόν,
ἐκ τούτων τὰ φαινόμενα πάντα καὶ διὰ τούτων ἀποτε-
λεῖ. καὶ γὰρ περὶ γῆς εἶρηκε πολλὰ καὶ περὶ οὐρανοῦ
καὶ ἡλίου καὶ σελήνης καὶ ἄστρον καὶ γένεσιν ἀν-
θρώπων ἀφήγηται.¹

¹ ἀφήρηται mss., corr. Wyttenbach

A Methodological Exhortation (D10)

D10 (B4) Clem. Alex. *Strom.* 5.15.5 (et al.)

λεῦσσε δ' ὁμῶς ἀπεόντα νόῳ παρεόντα
βεβαίως·
οὐ γὰρ ἀποτμήξει τὸ ἐὼν τοῦ ἐόντος ἔχουσθαι
οὔτε σκιδνάμενον πάντῃ πάντως κατὰ κόσμον
οὔτε συνιστάμενον. υ υ | – υ υ | – υ υ | – –

1 λεῦσσε Theod. *Cur.* 1.72 (BL): λεῦσε ms.

PARMENIDES

*Fragments and Reports from the Second Part of
the Poem: The Opinions of Mortals (D9–D62)
An Overview of the Contents of the
Second Part (D9)*

D9 (cf. ad B10) Plutarch, *Against Colotes*

Parmenides [. . .] has also described in his poem the arrangement of the world, and after he has mixed the elements, the bright and the dark, he produces all the phenomena out of them and by means of them. For he has said many things about the earth, the heavens, the sun, the moon and the heavenly bodies, and he recounts the origin of human beings.

A Methodological Exhortation (D10)

D10 (B4) Clement of Alexandria, *Stromata* (et al.)

**See these things, which, remote though they
are, are firmly present to thought (noos).
For you [or: it] will not cut off what is from
cohering with what is,
Whether it is dispersed completely everywhere
throughout the world
Or is collected together.**

*Announcements of the Explanation of
Heavenly Bodies (D11–D12)*

D11 (B11) *Simpl. In Cael.*, p. 559.20–27

Παρμενίδης δὲ περὶ τῶν αἰσθητῶν “ἄρξασθαί” φησι
“λέγειν”

– υ υ | – πῶς γαῖα καὶ ἥλιος ἡδὲ σελήνη
αἰθήρ τε ξυνὸς γάλα τ’ οὐράνιον καὶ Ὀλυμπος
ἔσχατος ἡδ’ ἄστρον θερμὸν μένος ὥρμήθησαν
γίγνεσθαι υ υ | – υ υ | – υ υ | – υ υ | – –

καὶ τῶν γινομένων καὶ φθειρομένων μέχρι τῶν μορίων
τῶν ζώων τὴν γένεσιν παραδίδωσι.¹

¹ παραδίδωσι DE: παραδεδώκασι A

D12 (B10) *Clem. Alex. Strom.* 5.138.1

εἴση δ’ αἰθερίαν τε φύσιν τά τ’ ἐν αἰθέρι πάντα
σήματα καὶ καθαρᾶς εὐαγέος ἡελίοιο
λαμπάδος ἔργ’ αἰδήλα καὶ ὁππόθεν ἐξεγένοντο,
ἔργα τε κύκλωπος πεύση περίφοιτα σελήνης
5 καὶ φύσιν, εἰδήσεις δὲ καὶ οὐρανὸν ἀμφὶς
ἔχοντα

¹ The term can mean ‘destructive,’ ‘completely visible,’ or else ‘hidden.’ ² The heavens, in the restricted sense that Parmenides gives the term (D23, cf. D18), separate Olympus on high from the lower regions.

PARMENIDES

Announcements of the Explanation of Heavenly Bodies (D11–D12)

D11 (B11) Simplicius, *Commentary on Aristotle's On the Heavens*

Regarding the sensibles, Parmenides says that he “begins to say”¹

**How the earth, the sun and the moon,
The aether in common and the heavenly milk,
farthest
Olympus and the hot strength of the stars strove
To be born**

and he teaches the origin of the things that are born and are destroyed, all the way to the parts of animals.

¹ Simplicius surely paraphrases the words that preceded the lines he is about to cite.

D12 (B10) Clement of Alexandria, *Stromata*

**You will know the aethereal nature, and in the
aether all
The signs, and of the pure torch of the brilliant
sun
The blinding works,¹ and from where they are
born,
And you will learn the recurrent [or: wandering]
works of the round-eyed moon
And its nature, and you will also know from
where the sky, which is on both sides,²**

5

ἔνθεν ἔφν τε καὶ ὥς μιν ἄγουσ' ἐπέδησεν
 Ἀνάγκη
 πείρατ' ἔχειν ἄστρον. υ υ | - υ υ | - υ υ | - -

6 μὲν γὰρ post ἔνθεν hab. ms.: del. Sylburg

Light and Night (D13)

D13 (B9) Simpl. *In Phys.*, p. 180.9–12

αὐτὰρ ἐπειδὴ πάντα φάος καὶ νύξ ὀνόμασται
 καὶ τὰ κατὰ σφετέρας δυνάμεις ἐπὶ τοῖσί τε καὶ
 τοῖς,
 πᾶν πλέον ἐστὶν ὁμοῦ φάεος καὶ νυκτὸς
 ἀφάντου
 ἴσων ἀμφοτέρων, ἐπεὶ οὐδετέρῳ μέτα μῆδέν.

1 ὀνόμασται F¹: ὠνόμασται DE F²

*The Beginnings of the Cosmogonic Process: The
 Wreaths, the Cosmogonic Divinity, and Other
 Gods (D14–D17)*

D14 (B12)

a Simpl. *In Phys.*, p. 39.12–13

μετ' ὀλίγα [scil. **D8.66**] δὲ πάλιν περὶ τῶν δυεῖν στοι-
 χείων εἰπὼν ἐπάγει καὶ τὸ ποιητικὸν λέγων οὕτως [. . .
 = **D14b.1–3**].

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**Was born and how Necessity led and enchained
it
To maintain the limits of the heavenly bodies.**

Light and Night (D13)

D13 (B9) Simplicius, *Commentary on Aristotle's Physics*

**But since all things have been named light and
night
And what belongs to their powers is assigned to
these and to those,
The whole is altogether full of light and of
ungleaming night,
Both of them equal, since nothing is amidst
either of them.**

*The Beginnings of the Cosmogonic Process: The
Wreaths, the Cosmogonic Divinity, and Other
Gods (D14–D17)*

D14 (B12)

a Simplicius, *Commentary on Aristotle's Physics*

A little after, having spoken once again about the two elements, he introduces the efficient [scil. cause] too, saying
[. . . = **D14b.1–3**].

b v. 1–3: Simpl. *In Phys.*, p. 39.14–16; v. 2–6: Simpl. *In Phys.*, p. 31.13–17

αἱ γὰρ στευνότεραι πλήντο πυρὸς ἀκρήτοιο,
αἱ δ' ἐπὶ ταῖς νυκτός, μετὰ δὲ φλογὸς ἴεται
αἶσα·

ἐν δὲ μέσῳ τούτων δαίμων ἦ πάντα κυβερνᾷ·
πάντων γὰρ στυγεροῖο τόκου καὶ μίξιος ἄρχει
5 πέμπουσ' ἄρσενι θήλυ μιγῇν τό τ' ἐναντίον
αὖτις

ἄρσεν θηλυτέρῳ. υ υ | – υ υ | – υ υ | – –

1 πλήντο Bergk: παήντο E^a: πάήντο D¹: πύήντο D²E: om.
F ἀκρήτοιο Stein: ἀκρήτοις D E^a: ἀκρίτοις EF: ἀκρίτοιο
ed. Ald. 4 πάντων γὰρ W: πάντα γὰρ DEF: πάντη γὰρ
Mullach: πᾶσιν γὰρ Stein: πάντα γὰρ <ῆ> Diels ἄρχει
DE: ἀρχῇ F 5 μιγῇν Bergk et Stein: μιγέν mss.

D15 (< A37)

a Aët. 2.7.1 (Stob., Ps.-Plut. usque στερεὸν ὑπάρχειν)
[περὶ τάξεως τοῦ κόσμου]

Παρμενίδης στεφάνας εἶναι περιπεπλεγμένους ἐπαλ-
λήλους,¹ τὴν μὲν ἐκ τοῦ ἀραιοῦ, τὴν δὲ ἐκ τοῦ πυκνοῦ·
μικτὰς δὲ ἄλλας² ἐκ³ φωτὸς καὶ σκοτοῦς μεταξὺ
τούτων· καὶ τὸ περιέχον δὲ πάσας τείχους δίκην στε-
ρεὸν ὑπάρχειν, ὅφ' ᾧ πυρώδης στεφάνη· καὶ τὸ με-
σαίτατον πασῶν περὶ ὃ⁴ πάλιν πυρώδης· τῶν δὲ συμ-
μιγῶν τὴν μεσαιτάτην ἀπάσαις †τε καὶ†⁵ πάσης

b Simplicius, *Commentary on Aristotle's Physics*

**For the narrower ones were filled with unmixed
fire,**

**The next ones with night, and afterward [or:
among these] there rushes a portion of flame.**

**And in the middle of these, the divinity who
steers all things.**

**For she begins the hateful birth and mingling of
all things,**

**Leading the female to mingle with the male and 5
again, in the opposite direction,**

The male with the female.

D15 (< A37)

a Aëtius

Parmenides: there are wreaths intertwined with one another, the one made out of the thin [scil. element], the other out of the dense one; and others, mixed out of light and darkness, are between these. What surrounds them all like a rampart is solid, under this is a fiery [scil. wreath]; and this is also the case of the most central point of them all, around which once again there is a fiery [scil. wreath]. The most central of the mixed [scil. wreaths] is for all of

¹ ἐπαλλήλους Stob. Plut MII: ἐπ' ἀλλήλας Plut. m: ἐπ' ἀλλήλαις Plut. Laur. 31.37 ² ἀλλήλας Plut. mss. (sed ἄλλας Eus. PE 15.38.1)

³ ἐκ Plut., deest in Stob. ⁴ περὶ ὁ Boeckh: περὶ ὄν F: περὶ ὦν P: post πασῶν coni. lac. Diels

⁵ locus corruptus: ἀπάσαις τοκέα Davis: ἀπάσαις αἰτίαν Krische: ἀρχὴν τε καὶ αἰτίαν Diels: alii alia

κινήσεως καὶ γενέσεως ὑπάρχειν, ἦντινα καὶ δαίμονα
κυβερνήτην καὶ κληροῦχον⁶ ἐπονομάζει, δίκην τε καὶ
ἀνάγκην [. . . = **D18**].

⁶ κληροῦχον mss.: κληδοῦχον Fülleborn

b Cic. *Nat. deor.* 1.28

nam Parmenides quidem commenticium¹ quiddam: cor-
nae similem² efficit (στεφάνην appellat), continentem
ardorum³ lucis⁴ orbem, qui cingit caelum, quem appellat
deum [. . . = **D17**].

¹ commenticium *dett. Rom. Ven.*, conventicium *ADHPOB*
FM, conventium *N* ² simile *OM*², similitudinem *P*

³ ardorum *B*¹, ardorem *cett.* ⁴ lucis *del. Pease*

D16 (B13) Simpl. *In Phys.*, p. 39.17–19

ταύτην καὶ θεῶν αἰτίαν εἶναί φησι λέγων

πρώτιστον μὲν Ἔρωτα θεῶν μητίσατο πάντων

καὶ τὰ ἑξῆς [. . . = **D61**].

D17 (< A37) Cic. *Nat. deor.* 1.28

[. . . = **D15b**] multaque eiusdem monstra, quippe qui
bellum, qui discordiam, qui cupiditatem, ceteraque gene-
ris eiusdem ad deum revocat [. . .]; eademque de sideribus
[. . . cf. **R59**].

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them <cause?> of all movement and generation, which he also calls ‘the divinity who steers’ and ‘the portion holder,’¹ ‘justice’ and ‘necessity.’

¹ Or, emending: ‘the key holder’ (cf. **D4.14**).

b Cicero, *On the Nature of the Gods*

For Parmenides [scil. produces] a fiction: something similar to a wreath (he calls it *stephanê*), a continuous circle of the flames of [or: of the heat of the] light that encircles the heaven; he calls this god [. . .].

D16 (B13) Simplicius, *Commentary on Aristotle’s Physics* (et al.¹)

He says that it [i.e. the divinity of **D14b.3**] is also the cause of the gods, when he says:

She² devised Eros as the very first of all the gods

and what follows [. . .].

¹ This line is also cited by Plato and Aristotle, among others; see **R56–R57**.

² Plutarch identifies this divinity with Aphrodite; see **R58**.

D17 (< A37) Cicero, *On the Nature of the Gods*

[. . .] and there are many monstrosities of the same man, for he assigns war, discord, greed, and the other things of this sort to a god [. . .]; and the same for the stars [. . .].

*Genesis and Order of the World:
A General Summary (D18)*

D18 (< A37) Aët. 2.7.1 (Stob.) [περὶ τάξεως τοῦ κόσμου]
[. . . = **D15a**] καὶ τῆς μὲν γῆς ἀπόκρισιν εἶναι τὸν
ἀέρα, διὰ τὴν βιαιοτέραν αὐτῆς ἐξατμισθέντα πύλη-
σιν, τοῦ δὲ πυρὸς ἀναπνοὴν τὸν ἥλιον καὶ τὸν γαλα-
ξίαν κύκλον· συμμιγῇ δ' ἐξ ἀμφοῖν εἶναι τὴν σελήνην,
τοῦ τ' ἀέρος καὶ τοῦ πυρός. περιστάντος δ' ἀνωτάτω
πάντων τοῦ αἰθέρος ὑπ' αὐτῷ τὸ πυρῶδες ὑποταγῆναι
τοῦθ' ὅπερ κεκλήκαμεν οὐρανόν, ὑφ' ᾧ¹ ἤδη τὰ περιέ-
γεια.

¹ ᾧ Krische: οὐ mss.

*Genesis and Order of the World:
The Constitutive Parts (D19–D39)
Heavens (D19)*

D19 (< A38) Aët. 2.11.4 (Stob.) [περὶ τῆς οὐρανοῦ οὐ-
σίας]

Παρμενίδης [. . .] πύρινον εἶναι τὸν οὐρανόν.

Heavenly Bodies (D20)

D20 (< A39) Aët. 2.13.8 (Stob.) [περὶ οὐσίας ἄστρον]

Παρμενίδης [. . .] πιλήματα πυρὸς τὰ ἄστρα.

PARMENIDES

Genesis and Order of the World: A General Summary (D18)

D18 (< A37) Aëtius

[. . .] The air has separated out from the earth; it has evaporated because of the very violent pressure exerted upon it, while the sun and the Milky Way are an exhalation of fire. The moon is a mixture of both of them, of air and of fire. The aether occupies in a circle the highest position of all; below it is arranged the fiery [scil. region], which is what we call the sky; and under this finally are located the [scil. regions] that surround the earth.

Genesis and Order of the World: The Constitutive Parts (D19–D39) Heavens (D19)

D19 (< A38) Aëtius

Parmenides [. . .]: the heavens are fiery.

Heavenly Bodies (D20)

D20 (< A39) Aëtius

Parmenides [. . .]: the heavenly bodies are concentrations of fire.

Fixed Stars (D21)

D21 (< A40) Anon. *Introd. Arat.* 14

[. . .] τῶν μὲν ἀπλανῶν [. . .] τὰ μὲν ἀκατονόμαστα
ἡμῖν καὶ ἀπερίληπτα, ὥς καὶ Παρμενίδης ὁ φυσικὸς
εἴρηκε [. . .].

The Evening Star—The Morning Star (Venus)
(D22–D23)

D22 (< A1, cf. A40a) Diog. Laert. 9.23

καὶ δοκεῖ πρῶτος πεφωρακέναι τὸν αὐτὸν εἶναι Ἑσπε-
ρον καὶ Φωσφόρον, ὥς φησι Φαβωρίνος ἐν πέμπτῳ
Ἀπομνημονευμάτων [Frag. 54 Amato]. οἱ δὲ Πυθα-
γόραν.

D23 (A40a) Aët. 2.15.7 (Stob.) [περὶ ταξέως ἀστέρων]

Παρμενίδης πρῶτον μὲν τάττει τὸν ἑῶν, τὸν αὐτὸν δὲ
νομιζόμενον ὑπ' αὐτοῦ καὶ Ἑσπερον, ἐν τῷ αἰθέρι· μεθ'
ὃν τὸν ἥλιον, ὑφ' ᾧ τοὺς ἐν τῷ πυρῶδει ἀστέρας, ὅπερ
οὐρανὸν καλεῖ.

Milky Way (D24)

D24 (A43a) Aët. 3.1.4 (Ps.-Plut.) [περὶ τοῦ γαλαξίου
κύκλου]

Παρμενίδης τὸ τοῦ πυκνοῦ καὶ ἀραιοῦ μίγμα γαλα-
κτοειδὲς ἀποτελέσαι χρῶμα.

PARMENIDES

Fixed Stars (D21)

D21 (< A40) Anonymous Introduction to Aratus' *Phaenomena*

[. . .] of the fixed stars [. . .], some are not named by us and cannot be apprehended [or: counted], as Parmenides the natural philosopher says too [. . .].

The Evening Star—The Morning Star (Venus) (D22–D23)

D22 (< A1, cf. A40a) Diogenes Laertius

He seems to have been the first person to have discovered that the evening star and the one that brings the light are the same, as Favorinus says in the fifth book of his *Memoirs*; others say that it was Pythagoras [cf. **PYTH. c D14**].

D23 (A40a) Aëtius

Parmenides puts in first place the morning star, which he considers to be the same as the evening star, in the aether; after this the sun, and under this latter the heavenly bodies of the fiery [scil. region], which he calls 'sky' [cf. **D11**].

Milky Way (D24)

D24 (A43a) Aëtius

Parmenides: the mixture of the dense and the thin produces the milky color [scil. of the Milky Way].

EARLY GREEK PHILOSOPHY V

Birth of the Sun and Moon (D25)

D25 (A43) Aët. 2.20.8a (Stob.) [περὶ οὐσίας ἡλίου]

Παρμενίδης τὸν ἥλιον καὶ τὴν σελήνην ἐκ τοῦ γαλαξίου κύκλου ἀποκριθῆναι, τὸν μὲν ἀπὸ τοῦ ἀραιότερου μίγματος, ὃ δὴ θερμόν, τὴν δὲ ἀπὸ τοῦ πυκνοτέρου, ὅπερ ψυχρόν.

The Sun: Its Nature (D26)

D26 (< A41) Aët. 2.20.8 (Stob.) [περὶ οὐσίας ἡλίου]

Παρμενίδης [. . .] πύρινον ὑπάρχειν τὸν ἥλιον.

The Moon: Its Nature, Size, and Appearance (D27–D31)

D27 (B14) Plut. Adv. Col. 15 1116A

[. . .] τὴν σελήνην [. . .] κατὰ Παρμενίδην

νυκτὶ φάος περὶ γαῖαν ἀλώμενον ἀλλότριον
φῶς

νυκτὶ φάος mss.: νυκτιφαῆς Scaliger

D28 (B15) Plut. Fac. orb. lun. 16.6 929B

αἰεὶ παπταίνουσα πρὸς αὐγὰς ἡελίοιο

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Birth of the Sun and Moon (D25)

D25 (A43) Aëtius

Parmenides: the sun and the moon were separated out from the Milky Way, the former from the thinner mixture, which is hot, the latter from the denser one, which is cold.

The Sun: Its Nature (D26)

D26 (< A41) Aëtius

Parmenides [. . .]: the sun is fiery.

The Moon: Its Nature, Size, and Appearance (D27–D31)

D27 (B14) Plutarch, *Against Colotes*

[. . .] the moon [. . .] according to Parmenides,

**A light (*phaos*) in the night wandering around
the earth, a light (*phôs*) from elsewhere¹**

¹ *Phôs* is a homonym of the Homeric term designating a mortal in the formula *allotrion phôs* ('a man from elsewhere').

D28 (B15) Plutarch, *On the Face in the Moon*

Always gazing toward the rays of the sun

D29 (A42) Aët. 2.26.2 (Ps.-Plut.) [περὶ μεγέθους σελήνης]

Παρμενίδης ἴσῃν τῷ ἡλίῳ, καὶ ἀπ' αὐτοῦ φωτίζεσθαι.

D30 (A42) Aët. 2.25.3 (Stob.; cf. Theod.) [περὶ σελήνης οὐσίας]

Παρμενίδης πυρίνην.

D31 (B21) Aët. 2.30.4 (Stob.) [περὶ ἐμφάσεως αὐτῆς]

Παρμενίδης διὰ τὸ παραμεμῖχθαι τῷ περὶ αὐτὴν πυρώδει τὸ ζοφῶδες, ὅθεν ψευδοφανῇ¹ τὸν ἀστέρα καλεῖ.

¹ ψευδοφανῇ mss: ψευδοφαῇ Meineke

The Earth (D32–D39)

Its Birth (D32)

D32 (< A22) Ps.-Plut. *Strom.* 5 (Eus. *PE* 1.8.5)

λέγει δὲ τὴν γῆν τοῦ πυκνοῦ καταρρυνέντος ἀέρος γεγονέναι.

Its Shape and Position (D33–D35)

D33 Diog. Laert.

a (< A1) 9.21

πρῶτος δὲ οὗτος τὴν γῆν ἀπέφαινε σφαιροειδῇ καὶ ἐν μέσῳ κείσθαι.

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D29 (A42) Aëtius

Parmenides: [the moon is] equal in size to the sun, and it is illuminated by it.

D30 (A42) Aëtius

Parmenides: [the moon is] fiery.

D31 (B21) Aëtius

Parmenides: [scil. the fact that the moon seems to be similar to the earth is] because the dark is mixed with the fiery that surrounds it, and this is why he calls that heavenly body **‘false-shining.’**

The Earth (D32–D39) *Its Birth (D32)*

D32 (< A22) Ps.-Plutarch, *Stromata*

He says that the earth came to be when the dense air flowed down.

Its Shape and Position (D33–D35)

D33 Diogenes Laertius

a (< A1)

He was the first to assert that the earth is spherical in shape and rests in the center.

b (< A44) 8.48

ἀλλὰ μὴν καὶ τὸν οὐρανὸν πρῶτον ὀνομάσαι κόσμον
καὶ τὴν γῆν στρογγύλην, ὥς δὲ Θεόφραστος [Frag.
227E FSH&G] Παρμενίδην [. . .].

D34 (≠ DK) Schol. in Bas. *Hex.* 26

τὴν γῆν ἀκίνητον ἔφη Παρμενίδης ὁ Ἐλεάτης [. . .].

D35 (B15a) Schol. in Bas. *Hex.* 25

Παρμενίδης ἐν τῇ στιχοποιίᾳ ὑδατόριζον εἶπεν τὴν
γῆν.

Earthquakes (D36)

D36 (< A44) Aët. 3.15.7 (Ps.-Plut.) [περὶ σεισμῶν γῆς]

Παρμενίδης [. . .] διὰ τὸ πανταχόθεν ἴσον ἀφεςτῶσαν
μένειν ἐπὶ τῆς ἰσορροπίας, οὐκ ἔχουσιν αἰτίαν δι' ἣν
δεῦρο μᾶλλον ἢ ἐκεῖσε ῥέψειεν ἄν· διὰ τοῦτο μόνον
μὲν κραδαίνεσθαι μὴ κινεῖσθαι δέ.

Zones (D37–39)

D37 (cf. A44a) Ach. Tat. *Introd. Arat.* 31

πρῶτος δὲ Παρμενίδης ὁ Ἐλεάτης τὸν¹ περὶ τῶν ζωνῶν
ἐκίνησε λόγον.

¹ ὁ Ἐλεάτης τὸν Maass: ὁ στεατὴν τον V, om. M

PARMENIDES

b (< A44)

He [i.e. Pythagoras] was the first to call the heavens *kosmos* [i.e. a beautiful organized whole] and the earth ‘round’ [cf. **PYTH. c D13**]; but according to Theophrastus, it was Parmenides [. . .].

D34 (≠ DK) Scholia on Basil’s *Hexameron*

Parmenides of Elea said that the earth is immobile [. . .].

D35 (B15a) Scholia on Basil’s *Hexameron*

Parmenides in his poem called the earth ‘**water-rooted.**’

Earthquakes (D36)

D36 (< A44) Aëtius

Parmenides [. . .]: it [i.e. the earth] stays in place because it is equally distant from everywhere on account of its balance, having no reason why it should incline more in one direction than in another. It is for this reason that it is only shaken, but not moved.

Zones (D37–39)

D37 (cf. A44a) Achilles Tatius, *Introduction to Aratus’ Phaenomena*

Parmenides of Elea was the first to discuss the topic of the zones.

D38 (< A44a) Strabo 2.2.2

φησὶ δὴ ὁ Ποσειδώνιος [Frag. F49 Kidd] τῆς εἰς πέντε ζώνας διαιρέσεως ἀρχηγὸν γενέσθαι Παρμενίδην· ἀλλ' ἐκείνους μὲν σχεδὸν τι διπλασίαν ἀποφαίνειν τὸ πλάτος τὴν διακεκαυμένην τῆς μεταξὺ τῶν τροπικῶν,¹ ὑπερπίπτουσιν² ἑκατέρων τῶν τροπικῶν εἰς τὸ ἐκτὸς καὶ πρὸς ταῖς εὐκράτοις [. . .].

¹ τῆς . . . τροπικῶν secl. Kramer ² ὑπερπίπτουσιν Brequigny: -πιπτούσης mss.: -πίπτουσιν καὶ Groskurd

D39 (A44a) Aët. 3.11.4 (Ps.-Plut.) [περὶ θέσεως γῆς]

Παρμενίδης πρῶτος ἀφώρισε τῆς γῆς τοὺς οἰκουμένους τόπους ὑπὸ ταῖς δυσὶ ζώναις ταῖς τροπικαῖς.

Physiology (D40–D60)

Generation of Living Creatures (D40–D50)

The Role of Heat (D40–D43)

D40 (< A1) Diog. Laert. 9.22

γένεσιν τ' ἀνθρώπων ἐξ ἡλίου¹ πρῶτον γενέσθαι αὐτὸν² δὲ ὑπάρχειν τὸ θερμὸν καὶ τὸ ψυχρόν, ἐξ ὧν τὰ πάντα συνεστάναι.

¹ ἡλίου mss.: ἰλύος Frobenius ² αὐτὸν mss.: αἴτια Diels

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D38 (< A44a) Strabo, *Geography*

Posidonius says that Parmenides was the initiator of the division into five zones; but that he asserted that the torrid zone was almost twice as large as the one lying between the tropics, extending beyond each of the two tropics outward into the temperate zones.

D39 (A44a) Aëtius

Parmenides was the first to define the inhabited parts of the earth below the two tropical zones.

Physiology (D40–D60)

Generation of Living Creatures (D40–D50)

The Role of Heat (D40–D43)

D40 (< A1) Diogenes Laërtius

The genesis of human beings came about in the beginning from the sun; but he himself [i.e. the human being?] is¹ the hot and the cold, out of which all things are constituted.

¹ Or, emending: “the causes are . . .”

D41 (< A51) Cens. *Die nat.* 4.8

haec eadem opinio etiam in Parmenide Veliensi¹ fuit pauculis exceptis ab Empedocle dissensus.²

¹ Veliensi *vel* Veliate *edd.*: *locus corruptus incertus*

² *locus*

D42 (A53) Aët. 5.7.2 (Ps.-Plut.) [πῶς ἄρρενα γεννᾶται καὶ θήλεα]

Παρμενίδης ἀντιστρόφως· τὰ μὲν πρὸς τοῖς ἄρκοις ἄρρενα βλαστῆναι, τοῦ γὰρ πυκνοῦ μετέχειν¹ πλείονος· τὰ δὲ πρὸς ταῖς μεσημβρίαις θήλεα παρὰ τὴν ἀραιότητα.

¹ μετέχει mss., corr. Diels

D43 (< A52) Arist. *PA* 2.2 648a29–31

[. . .] Παρμενίδης τὰς γυναικας τῶν ἀνδρῶν θερμότερας εἶναί φησι καὶ ἕτεροί τινες, ὥς διὰ τὴν θερμότητα καὶ πολυαιμούσαις γινομένων τῶν γυναικείων [. . . = **EMP. D173b**].

Seed (D44–D45)

D44 (< 24 A13) Cens. *Die nat.* 5.4

illud quoque ambiguum facit inter auctores opinionem, utrumne ex patris tantummodo semine partus nascatur [. . .] an etiam ex matris, quod [. . .] Parmenidi [. . .] visum est.

PARMENIDES

D41 (< A51) Censorinus, *The Birthday*

The same opinion [scil. as Empedocles', cf. **EMP. D172**] was held by Parmenides of Elea, with a very few exceptions in which he differed from Empedocles.

D42 (A53) Aëtius

It is the opposite for Parmenides [scil. from Empedocles, cf. **EMP. D174**]: males grow in the north, for they have a greater share in what is dense; females in the south, because of the thinness.

D43 (< A52) Aristotle, *Parts of Animals*

[. . .] Parmenides and some other people say that women are warmer than men, on the supposition that menstruation comes about because of heat and for women with abundant blood [. . .].¹

¹ Cf. Arist. GA 4.1 765b17–26.

Seed (D44–D45)

D44 (< 24 A13) Censorinus, *The Birthday*

The following question too causes a difference of opinion among the authorities: whether the child is born only from the father's seed [. . .] or also from the mother's, which is the opinion of [. . .] Parmenides [. . .].

D45 (A53) Cens. *Die nat.* 5.2

Parmenides enim tum ex dextris tum e laevis partibus id ire¹ putavit.

¹ *verba id ire fortasse corrupta: oriri ed. Rostoch.*

Determination of the Sex (D46–D48)

D46 (B17) Gal. *In Hipp. Epid.* 6.2.46, p. 119.12–15

τὸ μέντοι ἄρρεν ἐν τῷ δεξιῷ μέρει τῆς μήτρας κυίσκεσθαι καὶ ἄλλοι τῶν παλαιοτάτων ἀνδρῶν εἰρήκασιν. ὁ μὲν γὰρ Παρμενίδης οὕτως ἔφη,

δεξιτεροῖσιν μὲν κούρους, λαιοῖσι δὲ κούρας

δεξιτεροῖσι mss., corr. Karsten δὲ Karsten: δ' αὖ mss.

D47 (< A53) Aët. 5.7.4 (Ps.-Plut.) [πῶς ἄρρενα γεννᾶται καὶ θήλεα]

[. . .] Παρμενίδης τὰ μὲν ἐκ τῶν δεξιῶν καταβάλλεσθαι εἰς τὰ δεξιὰ μέρη τῆς μήτρας, τὰ δ' ἐκ τῶν ἀριστερῶν εἰς τὰ ἀριστερά· εἰ δ' ἐναλλαγείη τὰ τῆς καταβολῆς, γίνεσθαι θήλεα.

D48 (A54) Cens. *Die nat.* 6.5

at inter se certare feminae et maris,¹ et penes utrum victoria sit, eius habitum referri auctor est Parmenides.

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D45 (A53) Censorinus, *The Birthday*

Parmenides thought that it [i.e. the seed] comes (?) sometimes from the right side, sometimes from the left.

Determination of the Sex (D46–D48)

D46 (B17) Galen, *Commentary on Hippocrates' Epidemics*

That the male is conceived in the right part of the womb has also been said by other very ancient men. For Parmenides said as follows:

On the right the boys, on the left the girls

D47 (< A53) Aëtius

[...] Parmenides: the ones [scil. seeds] that come from the right side are expelled into the right side of the womb, the ones from the left side into the left side. But if the expulsion is reversed, females are born.

D48 (A54) Censorinus, *The Birthday*

Parmenides established the doctrine that those [scil. probably: the seeds] of the female and of the male fight against each other and that it is the condition of the one that wins that is reproduced.

¹ *feminae et maris plerique: feminas et mares V² (et recc.): mares et foeminas L: <semina> feminae Giusta*

EARLY GREEK PHILOSOPHY V

Determination of the Character (D49)

D49 (B18) Cael. Aurel. *Tard. Pass.* 4.9.134–35

Parmenides libris, quos de natura scripsit, eventu inquit conceptionis molles aliquando seu subactos homines generari. [. . .]

femina, virque simul Veneris cum germina miscent,
venis informans diverso ex sanguine virtus
temperiem servans bene condita corpora fingit.
nam si virtutes permixto semine pugnent
5 nec faciant unam permixto in corpore dirae,
nascentem gemino vexabunt semine sexum.

2 informans *edd.*: conformans *coni. Diels* 4 nam *ed.*
Bas.: at *edd. Lug. Hal.* 5 permixto *ed. Bas.*: virtutem
Bendz.: vim mixto *coni. ed. Lug.*: mixtae uno *coni. Th. Gomperz*

Resemblances (D50)

D50 (A54) Aët. 5.11.2 (Ps.-Plut.) [πόθεν γίνονται τῶν γονέων αἱ ὁμοιώσεις καὶ τῶν προγόνων]

Παρμενίδης· ὅταν μὲν ἀπὸ τοῦ δεξιοῦ μέρους τῆς μήτρας ὁ γόνος ἀποκριθῇ, τοῖς πατράσιν· ὅταν δ' ἀπὸ τοῦ ἀριστεροῦ, ταῖς μητράσιν.

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Determination of the Character (D49)

D49 (B18) Caelius Aurelianus, *On Chronic Diseases*

In the books that he wrote on nature, Parmenides says that at the moment of conception soft or submissive men are sometimes generated. [. . .]

When the woman and the man mix together the
seeds of Venus,
The power that is formed in the veins out of the
different kinds of blood
Fashions well constructed bodies if it maintains a
balance.
For if the powers fight when the seed is thoroughly
mixed
And, dreadful, are not unified in a thoroughly mixed 5
body,
They will disturb the newborn sex with a double
seed.¹

¹ What follows paraphrases this passage, restricting its explanation of character in general to the case of homosexuality.

Resemblances (D50)

D50 (A54) Aëtius

Parmenides: when the seed is separated from the right side of the womb, [scil. the children resemble] the fathers; when it is from the left side, the mothers.

Thought and Sensation (D51–D57)

General Principles (D51–D52)

D51 (B16) Arist. *Metaph.* Γ5 1009b22–25; Theophr. *Sens.* 3

ὥς γὰρ ἕκαστοτ' ἔχει κράσιν μελέων
πολυπλάγκτων,
τὼς νόος ἀνθρώποισι παρέστηκεν· τὸ γὰρ αὐτό
ἔστιν ὅπερ φρονέει μελέων φύσις ἀνθρώποισιν
καὶ πᾶσιν καὶ παντί· τὸ γὰρ πλέον ἐστὶ νόημα.

1 ἕκαστοτ' Arist. E¹J, Theophr. (ἐκάστοτε): ἕκαστος Arist.
E²: ἐκάστῳ Arist. A^b πολυπλάγκτων Theophr.: πολυ-
κάμπτων Arist. 2 παρέστηκεν Theophr.: παρίσταται Arist.

D52 (< A46) Theophr. *Sens.* 1 et 3–4

[1] [. . .] Παρμενίδης [. . .] τῷ ὁμοίῳ [. . .] [3] Παρμενί-
δης μὲν γὰρ ὅλως οὐδέν ἀφώρικεν ἀλλὰ μόνον ὅτι
δνοῖν ὄντοι στοιχείου κατὰ τὸ ὑπερβάλλον ἐστὶν ἢ
γνώσις. εἰ γὰρ ὑπεραίρη τὸ θερμόν ἢ τὸ ψυχρόν,
ἄλλην γίνεσθαι τὴν διάνοιαν, βελτίῳ δὲ καὶ καθαρω-
τέραν τὴν διὰ τὸ θερμόν· οὐ μὴν ἀλλὰ καὶ ταύτην
δεῖσθαι τινος συμμετρίας [. . . = **D51**]· [4] τὸ γὰρ αἰ-
σθάνεσθαι καὶ τὸ φρονεῖν ὥς ταῦτ' ἄλλοι λέγουσι, διὸ καὶ τὴν
μνήμην καὶ τὴν λήθην ἀπὸ τούτων γίνεσθαι διὰ τῆς
κράσεως [. . . = **R61**]· ὅτι δὲ καὶ τῷ ἐναντίῳ καθ' αὐτὸ
ποιεῖ τὴν αἴσθησιν φανερόν, ἐν οἷς φησι τὸν νεκρὸν
φωτὸς μὲν καὶ θερμὸς καὶ φωνὴς οὐκ αἰσθάνεσθαι

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Thought and Sensation (D51–D57)

General Principles (D51–D52)

D51 (B16) Aristotle, *Metaphysics*; Theophrastus, *On Sensations*

**For just as it possesses each time the mixture of
much-wandering limbs,¹**

**So too thinking (*noos*) presents itself to humans:
for it is the same**

**That the nature of the limbs apprehends
(*phronein*) in humans,**

**Both in all and in each; for the full [or: the more]
is thought (*noêma*).**

¹ According to the text of Aristotle: “with numerous curvings.”

D52 (< A46) Theophrastus, *On Sensations*

[1] Parmenides [. . .] [scil. explains sensation] by the similar [. . .]. [3] Parmenides did not define anything at all except that, the elements being two in number, knowledge is in accordance with the one that prevails. For when the hot or the cold dominates, the thought becomes different. The better and the purer one of the two is the one produced by what is hot; but this one too requires a certain commensurability. [. . .] [4] For he speaks of sensation and thinking as being the same thing; this is why, for him, both memory and forgetting come about from these elements, by their mixture. [. . .] But the fact that he also explains sensation by one of the contraries taken by itself is clear from the passages in which he says that a corpse does not perceive light, heat, and sound, because fire has with-

EARLY GREEK PHILOSOPHY V

διὰ τὴν ἔκλειψιν τοῦ πυρός, ψυχροῦ δὲ καὶ σιωπῆς καὶ
τῶν ἐναντίων αἰσθάνεσθαι, καὶ ὅλως δὲ πᾶν τὸ ὄν
ἔχειν τινὰ γνῶσιν [. . . = **R61**].

*Doxographies Concerning the Soul,
Knowledge, and Sensations (D53–D57)
The Nature and Seat of the Soul (D53–D56)*

D53

a (< A1) Diog. Laert. 9.22

καὶ τὴν ψυχὴν καὶ τὸν νοῦν ταῦτόν εἶναι, καθὰ μέμνη-
ται καὶ Θεόφραστος ἐν τοῖς Φυσικοῖς [Frag. 227D
FHS&G].

b (< A45) Aët. 4.5.12 (Stob.) [περὶ τοῦ ἡγεμονικοῦ]

Παρμενίδης [. . .] ταῦτόν νοῦν καὶ ψυχὴν¹ [. . .].

¹ νοῦς καὶ ψυχὴ mss., corr. Diels

D54 (< A45) Aët. 4.3.4 (Stob.) [εἰ σῶμα ἢ ψυχὴ καὶ τίς
ἢ οὐσία αὐτῆς]

Παρμενίδης [. . .] πυρώδη.

D55 (A45) Macr. *In Somn.* 1.14.20

Parmenides ex terra et igne.

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drawn, but does perceive cold, silence, and the contraries, and in general that everything that exists possesses some knowledge.

*Doxographies Concerning the Soul,
Knowledge, and Sensations (D53–D57)
The Nature and Seat of the Soul (D53–D56)*

D53

a (< A1) Diogenes Laertius

The soul and the intellect are identical, as Theophrastus reports in his *Physics* [. . .].

b (< A45) Aëtius

Parmenides [. . .]: the intellect and the soul are identical [. . .].

D54 (< A45) Aëtius

Parmenides [. . .]: it [scil. the soul] is fiery.

D55 (A45) Macrobius, *Commentary on Cicero's Dream of Scipio*

Parmenides: [the soul is made] of earth and fire.

D56 (< A45) Aët. 4.5.5 (Ps.-Plut.) [περὶ τοῦ ἡγεμονικοῦ]

Παρμενίδης [. . .] ἐν ὅλῳ τῷ θώρακι.

Sensations (D57)

D57 (< A47) Aët. 4.9.6 (Stob.; cf. Ps.-Plut.) [εἰ ἀληθεῖς αἰ αἰσθήσεις]

Παρμενίδης¹ [. . .] παρὰ² τὰς συμμετρίας τῶν πόρων
τὰς κατὰ μέρος αἰσθήσεις γίνεσθαι τοῦ οἰκείου, τῶν
αἰσθητῶν ἐκάστων³ ἐκάστη⁴ ἐναρμόττοντος.⁵

¹ Παρμενίδης om. Plut.

² παρὰ Plut.: περὶ Stob.

³ ἐκάστων om. Plut.

⁴ ἐκάστη Plut.: ἐκάστην Stob.

⁵ ἐναρμόττοντος Diels: ἀναρμόττοντος Stob.: ἀρμόζοντος Plut.

Physiological Phenomena (D58–D60)

Appetite (D58)

D58 (< A50) Aët. 4.9.14 (Stob.) [εἰ ἀληθεῖς αἰ αἰσθήσεις]

Παρμενίδης [. . .] ἐλλεύπει τροφῆς τὴν ὄρεξιν.¹

¹ post ὄρεξιν lac. posuit Meineke

Sleep (D59)

D59 (< A46b) Tert. An. 43.2

[. . .] Parmenides refrigerationem.

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D56 (< A45) Aëtius

Parmenides: [scil. the directive part of the soul is located] in the whole chest.

Sensations (D57)

D57 (< A47) Aëtius

Parmenides [. . .]: the particular perceptions of what is appropriate for them come about thanks to the commensurability of the passages, each of the perceptibles adapting itself to each of them.¹

¹ It is possible that the idea of the commensurability of the passages is the result of a retroactive projection.

Physiological Phenomena (D58–D60) *Appetite (D58)*

D58 (< A50) Aëtius

Parmenides [. . .]: appetite [scil. comes about] from lack of food.¹

¹ This notice is found in a chapter entitled “Whether sensations are truthful,” in a section specifically dedicated to the sensations of pleasure and pain (cf. **EMP. D203a**); it may be lacunose.

Sleep (D59)

D59 (< A46b) Tertullian, *On the Soul*

[. . .] Parmenides: [scil. sleep] is a cooling down [. . .].

Old Age (D60)

D60 (A46a) Aët. 5.30.4 (Stob.) [περὶ ὑγείας καὶ νόσου καὶ γήρωσ]

Παρμενίδου γήρας γίνεσθαι παρὰ τὴν τοῦ θερμοῦ ὑπόλειψιν.

An Eschatology: The Circulation of Souls? (D61)

D61 (cf. B13) Simpl. *In Phys.*, p. 39.19–20

[. . . = **D16**] καὶ τὰς ψυχὰς πέμπειν ποτὲ μὲν ἐκ τοῦ ἐμφανοῦς¹ εἰς τὸ αἰεδές, ποτὲ δὲ ἀνάπαλιν φησιν.

¹ ἐμφανοῦς FE²: ἀφανοῦς DE¹

The End of Parmenides' Poem? (D62)

D62 (B19) Simpl. *In Cael.*, p. 558.7–11

παραδοὺς δὲ τὴν τῶν αἰσθητῶν διακόσμησιν ἐπ-
ήγαγε πάλιν·

οὕτω τοι κατὰ δόξαν ἔφυ τάδε καὶ νυν ἔασι
καὶ μετέπειτ' ἀπὸ τοῦδε τελευτήσουσι τραφέντα·
τοῖς δ' ὄνομ' ἄνθρωποι κατέθεντ' ἐπίσημον
ἐκάστω.

PARMENIDES

Old Age (D60)

D60 (A46a) Aëtius

Parmenides: old age comes about from lack of heat.

An Eschatology: The Circulation of Souls? (D61)

D61 (cf. B13) Simplicius, *Commentary on Aristotle's Physics*

[. . .] And he says that she [i.e. the divinity of **D14b**] sends the souls sometimes from the visible to the invisible, sometimes in the opposite direction.

The End of Parmenides' Poem? (D62)

D62 (B19) Simplicius, *Commentary on Aristotle's On the Heavens*

After he has explained the organization of the perceptibles, he has added once again:

**In this way, according to opinion, these things
have been born and now they are,
And later, having grown strong, starting from
that point they will come to their end.
For these things, humans have established a
name that designates each one.¹**

¹ This may well be the end of the goddess' speech, and perhaps indeed also of the poem as a whole.